Comments from Indian finance minister Morarji Desai, who had taken over from Krishnamachari, played into these concerns. On a visit to Washington, he linked a lack of aid with political instability and stressed that communists would take advantage of any loss of economic momentum. But Desai also gave American policymakers hope, stressing that his government was successfully combating domestic communists, including through economic development.[141] And Nehru assured the House Judiciary Committee chairman that India would soon "go ahead at a faster pace."[142]

Creeping Concern about China: The Infiltration of Ideas, Influence, and Individuals (1956–1958)

The newfound US-India bonhomie was not just facilitated by aid but also by India's shifting attitude toward China. Toward the end of 1958, intelligence analysts outlined the factors that would most affect US-India political relations: American military aid to Pakistan, the American approach toward alliances, and the two countries' China policies.[143] And on China, India's perception had already changed.

Changing Indian Perceptions

The question of the Sino-Indian border, consisting of western, middle, and eastern sectors, was a key element in the changing Indian view of China. In May 1956, with new Chinese maps—duplicated by the Soviets—continuing to show swaths of what India considered its territory as part of China, "occasional petty raids," and a Chinese infrastructure buildup in Tibet, Nehru expressed "a sense of disquiet." He and his officials had repeatedly stated to their Chinese interlocutors that India considered the frontier "firm," but now it appeared "China never clearly accepted our frontier as it is."[144] The Indian foreign secretary advised against raising the issue of the entire boundary with Beijing at that point, but he agreed with Joint Secretary Triloki Nath (T. N.) Kaul that specific points of dispute should be raised. Kaul had also suggested using the potential exploitation of Sino-Indian differences by "some Western countries" in negotiations with Chinese officials.[145]

Doubts about the Chinese attitude toward the border grew. The Sino-Burmese border dispute flared up in July 1956. China's subsequent